Last-Minute Halloween Costume Checklist 2026

Thu., Oct. 29 to Sat., Oct. 31, 2026

BEFORE YOU DRIVE

- [ ] Search the Spirit Halloween store locator by city or ZIP code — Thu., Oct. 29
- [ ] Call the store or open its page to confirm hours — Thu., Oct. 29
- [ ] Check the Staples store page for a Party City shop — Thu., Oct. 29
- [ ] Look at Target Drive Up or Order Pickup options — Thu., Oct. 29
- [ ] Write down every size you need and a backup costume idea — Thu., Oct. 29
- [ ] Ask whether wigs, props or shoes are sold separately — Thu., Oct. 29

COSTUME

- [ ] Buy the costume and any accessories — Fri., Oct. 30
- [ ] Try everything on at home — Fri., Oct. 30
- [ ] Skip decorative contact lenses unless a doctor prescribed them (FDA) — Fri., Oct. 30
- [ ] Make sure masks leave clear vision and room to breathe — Fri., Oct. 30
- [ ] Test face paint on a small patch of skin first — Fri., Oct. 30
- [ ] Keep receipts; seasonal items can have special return terms — Fri., Oct. 30

TRICK-OR-TREAT NIGHT

- [ ] Check your town's trick-or-treat hours — Sat., Oct. 31
- [ ] Charge a phone and pack a flashlight — Sat., Oct. 31
- [ ] Add reflective tape or a glow stick to dark costumes — Sat., Oct. 31
- [ ] Agree on a route and a meet-up time — Sat., Oct. 31
- [ ] Check treats at home before anyone eats them — Sat., Oct. 31

My notes

Source: U.S. Food and Drug Administration; Target; Spirit Halloween store locator.